Production Readiness Timeline

What Is Already Built and Live

Area	Status
Frontend (web app)	Live — all screens built and deployed
Backend API (FastAPI)	Live — deployed and connected to database
Database (MongoDB Atlas)	Live — user data persisting
Email / password auth	Working
Google sign-in	Built — needs end-to-end test
Digital wardrobe (add, view, delete items)	Built
AI clothing tagger (auto-labels photos)	Built — needs API key to activate
AI stylist (generates outfits from wardrobe)	Built — needs API key to activate
Lookbooks (editorial inspo + recreate with items)	Built
Camera roll bulk scan	Built
Outfit saving and favourites	Built
User onboarding flow	Built

What Is Still Needed Before Production

Phase 1 — Make It Fully Functional (1–2 weeks)

These are blockers. The app is live but key features are inactive until these are resolved.

Task	Effort	Why It Matters
Add OpenAI API key to backend	1 hour	Without it, AI tagging and the stylist return nothing — the app's core differentiators.
Set a real JWT secret	1 hour	Currently using a default dev value. Must be changed before real users sign in.
Test Google sign-in end to end	1 day	The flow is built but depends on a third-party OAuth proxy. Needs a verified pass on real devices.
Full QA pass on all screens	3–4 days	Click through every screen on web (desktop + mobile browser) and log any broken flows.

End of Phase 1: The app is feature-complete and usable by real users for a private beta.

Phase 2 — Production Hardening (2–3 weeks)

The app works but is not safe or scalable at volume.

Task	Effort	Why It Matters
Migrate image storage off MongoDB	4–5 days	Images stored as base64 inside DB records. MongoDB has a 16 MB doc limit — a user with 50+ items will hit errors. Need Cloudinary or S3.
Forgot password / password reset	2–3 days	No way for users to recover their account. Requires email sending (SendGrid or similar).
Rate limiting on the API	1 day	Without it, anyone can hammer AI endpoints and run up OpenAI costs.
Error monitoring (Sentry)	1 day	Errors are invisible unless logs are checked manually. Need alerts when things break.
Brand recognition ('Identified' mode)	3–5 days	App has a toggle for identifying exact brand/product of an item, but it currently returns nothing. Requires Ximilar or Google Lens integration.

End of Phase 2: The app is production-safe for a public launch on web.

Phase 3 — Native Mobile App (4–6 weeks, if required)

If the client wants an iOS/Android app in the App Store, this is a separate workstream. The codebase is already built in React Native (Expo), so no rewrite is needed — this is configuration and platform compliance work only.

Task	Effort
Set up Expo EAS Build (cloud build pipeline)	2–3 days
iOS-specific fixes (camera permissions, image picker)	3–5 days
Android-specific fixes	2–3 days
Apple Developer account + App Store submission	1–2 weeks (Apple review)
Google Play account + submission	3–5 days (faster review)
Push notifications (outfit reminders, new lookbooks)	3–4 days

Summary Timeline

Milestone	Target
AI features active, auth confirmed working	Week 1–2
Private beta launch (invite only)	Week 2

Milestone	Target
Image storage fixed, password reset, rate limiting	Week 3–4
Public web launch	Week 4–5
Native iOS + Android apps submitted	Week 8–10
App Store / Play Store approval	Week 9–12

Key Risks

1. **Apple App Store review** — Apple typically takes 1–3 weeks and may reject the first submission. Budget 2 review cycles into the schedule.
2. **OpenAI API costs** — The AI stylist and tagger call GPT-4o per user request. With an active user base, costs can grow quickly. A per-user daily usage cap should be built into Phase 2.
3. **Google OAuth dependency** — Google sign-in currently routes through a third-party proxy. If that service changes, Google login breaks. Replacing it with a direct OAuth integration is recommended before a large public launch.

Not in Scope (Not Built, Not Planned)

The following are **not** part of the current codebase and would require a separate scoping conversation if the client wants them:

- Shopping / e-commerce integration (buy the identified item)
- Social features (share outfits, follow other users)
- Weather API integration for automatic outfit suggestions
- Subscription / paywall / in-app purchases
- Multi-language support

These can be scoped as a follow-on phase once the core app is stable.